would get very frustrated when something went wrong or didn't go our way. On those occasions, we would all look after each other, sharing candies or just talking to each other so we wouldn't feel alone. We all felt as if we were part of a special family, bonded together in a great adventure.

I also admire the resilience of the real Bharat—those ordinary Indians and Congresspersons I bonded with in Camp B. We were housed in the strangest of locations—right from wedding halls to farm fields to a vacant hospital (with yatris sleeping in wards and on hospital beds) and even in dharamshalas! During a rest day in Hingoli, Camp B turned into a dhobi ghat (washermen's hub) with patriotic songs ringing in the air! It was a surreal experience. Similarly, a middle-aged woman had joined us from Kerala. She was unable to communicate in any language other than Malayalam, but we somehow found a way to communicate with her. A young software engineer joined us from Pune armed with his laptop, so that he could be part of the Yatra and still be at work 'online'! Many times, my car became his portable charging point. Then there was the young couple who joined the Yatra with two infants, just to make sure they contributed their bit to this historical feat. On another day, the lunch hour was near a school, and instead of resting, many yatris began playing with the children in their playground. The schoolteachers finally gave up trying to control all of us, and even joined us in the festivities!

I have never experienced such 'positive' mass euphoria before. It genuinely felt as if we were part of a national movement, much like the freedom movement that our forefathers fought in and died for. That day, in fact every day of the Yatra, was like a festival. When I think back, I honestly cannot remember the hardships or pains we all faced. All I remember is the buoyant spirit of Bharat Jodo.

Today, as I sit back and reminisce about the Bharat Jodo Yatra, I am awash with a feeling of gratitude, pride and contentment. I can tell myself and my child that when my country was going through its darkest period post-Independence, I did my bit and stood for India! The Yatra is over, but the task of Bharat Jodo still lies before us. But as I always tell myself, '*Hum Honge Kamayab, Ek Din* (Together we shall overcome, one day).'